



PROGRESS REPORT

Digital divides: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-27

Edition of 2026-08-27 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

18 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

ESWATINI · MALAWI · MALI · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · NAMIBIA · NIGER · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SENEGAL · SIERRA LEONE · SOMALIA · TANZANIA · TOGO · UGANDA · ZIMBABWE · AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Eswatini

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Community innovation hubs	One hub, at Pigg's Peak	Two hubs; a third planned for the Shiselweni Region	ADVANCED

Malawi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
School internet connectivity	No national school-connectivity measure before 2025-08-01; the nearest earlier statement is that over 83,000 students across 81 higher-education institutions gained cheaper connectivity through the research network	85% of Malawi's 9,000 schools have limited or no internet access and about 900 have none at all, with lack of electricity and devices named as the main barriers; the World Bank is separately supporting connection of over 200 schools	BASELINE NOT HELD
Universal Service Fund	The base carries no statement of the fund's size, income, disbursement or projects before 2025-08-01	In operation and funded from the regulator's annual budget allocation, but the Director General stated that existing funding levels remain insufficient to meet the country's connectivity needs; a school connectivity project providing computer equipment runs under the fund, and secondary-school digital-skills work is stated to draw on it. No income, balance or disbursement figure is held for any year The regulator said on 2026-08-21 that it is evaluating Universal Service Fund mechanisms to subsidise consumer devices and to fund digital-literacy work, including a proposed one-tablet-one-student programme.	BASELINE NOT HELD

Mali

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Women's digital-training target	Did not exist	Target set; no interim figure published	ADVANCED

Mauritius

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Rodrigues in the national digital strategy	Did not exist as a national commitment	A cybersecurity working framework with a Mauritius-based team and a dedicated representative, a youth awareness project, and integration of the national sign-on and super-app through post office agents, building on the regional assembly's own roadmap of 6 May 2026 (2026-05)	ADVANCED

Mozambique

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
American-funded digital inclusion and connectivity programming	In delivery	Planned and running work slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down, with no replacement funder named	REGRESSED
Gender gap in access to credit	Women 31%, men 59% (2024)	Women 34%, men 66% (2025)	REGRESSED
Subsidised smartphone programme	Did not exist	700,000 subsidised smartphones under a government-led, donor-supported programme starting at US\$5m and able to grow to US\$25m, financed through microcredit and pay-as-you-go models, alongside the 5G and 4G coverage obligations attached to the spectrum licences	ADVANCED
Financial Inclusion Index	36.4 points (2024)	36.4 points (2025), classified moderate by the central bank; Cabo Delgado rose from 23.3 to 25.8	NO CHANGE
Urban and rural information and communications technology penetration	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 80% in urban areas against about 20% in rural areas (2025-10)	Baseline not held

Namibia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Regulator sector and market report series	Published; four editions on file, the latest reporting 2023 data	Published as an irregular series - an earlier Telecommunication Sector Market Report in October 2021, the Telecommunication Sector Market Report 2021 in November 2022, the ICT Sector Market Report 2022 in December 2023 and the ICT Sector Market Report 2023 in November 2024 - built on licensees' audited financial statements and the regulator's own portal data	NO CHANGE
Schools and health facilities without adequate connectivity	339 schools and 50 health centres lacking adequate connectivity (2025-06)	No later official figure; a research council account records 65.4% of schools connected in 2023, 1,311 of 2,004	NO CHANGE, NO LATER FIGURE PUBLISHED

Niger

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Rural access constraint on identity enrolment	BASELINE NOT HELD	An analyst warns of privacy breaches, state surveillance and systemic exclusion, with rural communities, migrants and those without foundational identity most exposed	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Nigeria

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Device affordability	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Sub-\$100 shipments down 34% year-on-year in Q2 2026 and the African average selling price up \$41 to \$202; Nigeria's own market down 11% in the quarter	WORSENER
Digital Futures programme for young people with disabilities	Did not exist	A four-and-a-half-year programme run by a disability-rights organisation with a philanthropic foundation to expand employment access for young people with disabilities through digital skills, entrepreneurship and inclusive employment pathways, opened in Lagos with the state disability office's stated support	ADVANCED
Gender gap in identity enrolment	BASELINE NOT HELD	38.8% of enrolled NIN holders are women against 61.1% men, a 22.3-point gap (2025-06)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Rwanda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Smart-device affordability fund	A design stage with the development bank as financial intermediary, phased pilots and social-category subsidy targeting	The same design stage, with no market assessment, pilot or disbursement figure held	NO CHANGE
Universal access or service fund	In force under a presidential order of 12 May 2023, with each licensee's annual contribution capped at 2.5% of the turnover of each category of regulated service	The same; the operative rate is a regulatory-board decision not held, and the most recent accounts held remain 2020/21, when Frw 3,828,837,334 was spent against a Frw 6,372,536,516 budget	NO CHANGE
Urban and rural internet use gap	Urban usage 57%, rural 19%	Urban usage 57%, rural 19%, unchanged because unreported	NO CHANGE

Senegal

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Population without connectivity	Baseline not held	40% of the population still without access to connectivity, on the minister's statement to parliament (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Sierra Leone

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Internet penetration	20.7% of the population online, 1.84m users (2025-01)	20.8% online, 1.85m users against 7.02m offline (2025-10)	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Telecom investment against usage	BASELINE NOT HELD	About US\$400m invested against a 60% usage gap, with 1GB at Le 18,000-25,000, roughly triple the 2018 price (2026-05)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Somalia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Smartphone financing programme	Did not exist	Targeting 100,000 affordable smartphones by end-2026 at a US\$19 deposit and US\$0.60 to US\$1.60 a day, repaid over mobile money and scored on SIM tenure and spend; a pilot recorded under 4% default (2026-05)	ADVANCED

Tanzania

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital transformation centre for rights and gender equity	EUR 3,000,000 committed, active	EUR 3,000,000 committed, active	NO CHANGE

Togo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Community network at Ati-Akakpe	Announced as imminent and not operating	Still only an imminent-launch announcement, with no operating record, user count or completion date	NO CHANGE

Uganda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
American-funded digital inclusion and connectivity programming	In delivery	Planned and running work slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down, with no replacement funder named	REGRESSED
Digital for Girls and Women Uganda	Active; EUR 2.25m, 2021-2025	The record still reads active; the stated period has elapsed with no closure, extension or results record held	NO CHANGE
Uganda Communications Universal Service and Access Fund	Operating; Q3 2025 outputs were 3,000 riders skilled, 4,900 tablets, laboratories in 70 secondary schools and 60 public access centres	Operating; cumulative reach stated as laboratories in more than 1,000 public secondary schools	NO CHANGE

Zimbabwe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Household computer ownership	14.2% of households (2020)	11.2% (2025); urban 21.2% against rural 4.7%	REGRESSED
Household internet access	50.1% of households (2020)	75.5% of households (2025); mobile handset ownership 96.4%, rural 94.5%, urban 99.2%	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Satellite retail service affordability	30,907 subscriptions (Q1 2025); hardware US\$350, the smaller unit US\$200, subscriptions from US\$30 a month, access reported as mostly urban	67,057 subscriptions (Q4 2025); members of parliament reported packages rising from about US\$65 to over US\$100	ADVANCED, IN SCALE ONLY; AFFORDABILITY UNCHANGED

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
Women and girls digital-inclusion accelerator	BASELINE NOT HELD	An industry-body accelerator backed by two private foundations opened its next call for digital-inclusion solutions for women and girls across India and sub-Saharan Africa, with a grant amount listed at INR 42,000,000	Baseline not held

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
COMESA Regional Digital Inclusion Strategy	Did not exist	In drafting under the World Bank-supported IDEA programme, with consultation on affordable connectivity and devices, skills gaps, accessibility and digital trust; no draft, drafter or adoption date published	ADVANCED

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.